

Sprint 1 Report

Executive Summary

We are building a simple, open platform that helps people discover and share local events beyond their immediate circles. Today, organizing or finding small, local gatherings is fragmented across private group chats, school tools, and closed social networks, making it hard for new residents, students, and young professionals to connect with their communities. Our website solves this by enabling users to easily create public events and for others nearby to browse, filter, and RSVP with a single click. By focusing on the essentials (user authentication, event creation, event browsing, and RSVPs), our MVP delivers the core social loop of “host → discover → join” without unnecessary complexity. This approach bridges the gap between private invite-only platforms and large-scale tools like Eventbrite, thus creating a lightweight, community-driven way to make local social life more open and accessible.

User Research

Personas

Persona 1 – The Organizer

Aged 18-40, students or young professionals who want to host social events but struggle to reach beyond their immediate friend groups. They currently rely on group chats, calls, or private event links (e.g., Partiful), which limits visibility.

Goals: Make it easy to announce events publicly, gather RSVPs, and reduce the hassle of managing invites across multiple platforms.

Pain Points: Scattered RSVPs, limited reach, manual coordination, and overreliance on private networks.

Persona 2 – The Attendee

Also aged 18-40, individuals seeking social activities and who want to find open local events without depending on invitations. They often hear about gatherings by chance or through social media.

Goals: Discover nearby, low-barrier events and easily join with one tap.

Pain Points: Fragmented information, inaccessible small events, cluttered or paywalled options, and difficulty tracking RSVPs.

User Journeys

Current State:

- **Organizer:** Messages friends or posts privately; cannot easily broadcast to the wider community.
- **Attendee:** Relies on word-of-mouth or social media; misses out on spontaneous, local activities.

Ideal State (with our website):

- **Organizer:** Opens our website, goes to “Host Event,” inputs details, publishes, event becomes visible to all nearby users, and sees RSVPs update in real time.
- **Attendee:** Opens our website, browses a clean list of local events, filters by category or date, taps to see details, RSVPs with one click, and event is saved under “My RSVPs.”

Pain Points Addressed:

- Centralized discovery of local events.
- Clearer RSVP tracking for both hosts and attendees.
- Reduced dependency on closed social networks. Faster, simpler event creation and discovery.

Problem Validation

From personal experiences, we can confirm that there is a strong interest among students in New Haven who feel that existing tools (Eventbrite, Partiful, CampusGroups) are either limited to private circles, or difficult to keep track of all the events across the various platforms. This gap validates the need for an open, location-based event discover tool.

Team Members: Bar Ben Harush, Itay Rubin, J.B. Horsley, Nick Sirias, Sharon Chen

Success Metrics

- User Engagement: ≥ 10 event views or 2 events created in week 1 of beta.
- RSVP Conversion: $\geq 60\%$ of browsers RSVP to at least one event.
- User Retention: $\geq 40\%$ return rate within two weeks.
- Qualitative Feedback: Positive comments about ease of finding or hosting events beyond personal circles.

Product Vision

Vision Statement: Our website will help people discover and host local social events without needing to rely on closed networks or invitations. Our mission is to make spontaneous community connection simple and accessible.

MVP Scope (5 Weeks)

- User authentication (sign up / log in / log out)
- Event creation form (title, description, date/time, location text)
- Event list view showing upcoming events chronologically
- Event detail page with RSVP button and attendee list
- Filtering by category and search by event name
- “My RSVPs” page for tracking attended events

Key Features (based on User Stories 1-12)

- Simple user registration and persistent login
- Create/edit/delete events (creator-only permissions)
- Browse chronological feed of upcoming events
- RSVP and cancel RSVP (one-click toggle)
- View attendees on event detail page
- Basic filters and search for faster discovery

Success Metrics

- ≥ 10 events created and 50 RSVPs within the first beta week
- $\geq 60\%$ RSVP conversion rate from event views
- $\geq 40\%$ return rate within 14 days
- $\geq 80\%$ of users report ease of finding or hosting events (post-test survey)

Wireframes

Link: <https://orbit-tilt-11991592.figma.site/>

Technical Architecture

Backend Framework: Django (Python) – chosen for rapid development, built-in auth system, and clean MVC structure.

Frontend: Django Template + Bootstrap (HTML/CSS/JS) – lightweight, fast to prototype, and easy to extend later if needed.

Database: PostgreSQL – relational schema supporting foreign keys and many-to-many RSVP relationships.

Deployment Platform: Replit (for MVP demo)

Product Backlog Summary

Sprint 2 Plan

Team Members: Bar Ben Harush, Itay Rubin, J.B. Horsley, Nick Sirias, Sharon Chen

Sprint Goal: Deploy a functional MVP to staging where users can sign up, create events, browse them, and RSVP.

Focus Area:

- Implement foundational authentication and session management.
- Build core event creation and listing features.
- Enable RSVP functionality with attendee tracking.
- Establish database migrations and seed sample data.
- Set up continuous integration (basic testing and review flow).

Planned Stories (examples)

#1 User Registration & Login

#2 Create Events

#3 Browse Events

#4 RSVP to Events

Team Capacity: 5 developers x ~2 hours per week = 10 hours per week

Dependencies:

- Authentication to be completed before RSVP functionality.
- Database schema to be finalized before event and RSVP models are implemented.

Risks:

- Potential database migration or ORM integration issues.
- Limited time for end-to-end testing before staging deploy.
- Learning curve with Django models and deployment configuration.

Deliverables by End of Sprint 2:

- Fully functional MVP deployed.
- Working authentication, event creation, event listing, and RSVP flow.
- Database seeded with sample events for testing.
- Initial user testing feedback collected to inform Sprint 3 improvements.

Sprint 3 Preview

Sprint Goal: Refine the MVP into a polished, testable beta version by improving event discovery, usability, and user retention features. Deliver a stable, visually cohesive product ready for initial user testing.

Focus Areas:

- Enhance event browsing with search and category filters for better discoverability.
- Implement “My RSVPs” page for users to easily manage upcoming events.
- Add event edit and delete options for creators to correct or remove listings.
- Improve UI/UX consistency across pages with refined Bootstrap styling and responsive design.
- Integrate basic analytics (page views, RSVPs per event) to measure engagement.
- Conduct usability testing sessions with 3-5 pilot users to gather feedback.

Planned User Stories (examples)

#5 Filter/Search Events

#6 My RSVPs List

#9 Event Creator Sees Attendees

#13 Edit My Event

#14 Delete My Event

#15 Basic Home Screen

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Tentative Total: 21 Story Points

Dependencies:

- Sprint 2 MVP must be deployed and stable.
- Authentication and event creation features should be fully functional before enhancements.

Risks:

- Scope creep if additional UX changes are added mid-sprint.
- Potential performance issues with search/filter if dataset grows.

Deliverable at End of Sprint 3: A functioning, user-testable beta of the website, featuring full event creation, browsing, and management workflows, plus feedback gathered to inform Sprint 4.

Team Organization

Members: Bar Ben Harush, Itay Rubin, J.B. Horsley, Nick Sirias, Sharon Chen

Roles:

- Scrum Master (Sprint 1): Nick Sirias (rotates each sprint)
- Product Owner Proxy: J.B. Horsley
- Developers: Bar Ben Harush, Itay Rubin, Sharon Chen

Communication Plan:

- Slack for updates
- GitHub for issues and reviews

Process Setup

Links to Github Project Board: <https://github.com/jbhorsley/icy-jungle>

Definition of Ready:

- User story has clear acceptance criteria
- Story points estimated
- Dependencies identified

Definition of Done:

- Code reviewed and merged to main
- All tests passing
- Feature visible and functional on staging
- Documentation updated